

PLSC 197 / SODA 110N: Social Data, Technology, and Artificial Intelligence

Christopher Zorn

October 2, 2026

Learning Like A Machine

Training data:

Message Subject	Label
TAKE ACTION: Your Donation Can Help Flip...	SPAM
Your provider would like you to schedule...	NOT SPAM
REMINDER: C-SoDA Research Round Up Octob...	NOT SPAM
RE: Hi everyone	NOT SPAM
Win a Free iPhone! Take this one-time q...	SPAM
Help with expenses	SPAM
 Maple Harvest Festival Tickets on Sal...	NOT SPAM
Dear Dr. Christopher Zorn: We Sincerely...	SPAM

Test data:

1. October 2026 MPSA Newsletter
2. Multi-Use 8-in-1 EZ Faucet and Sink Wrench
3. Absence Due To Illness
4. I seek your partnership

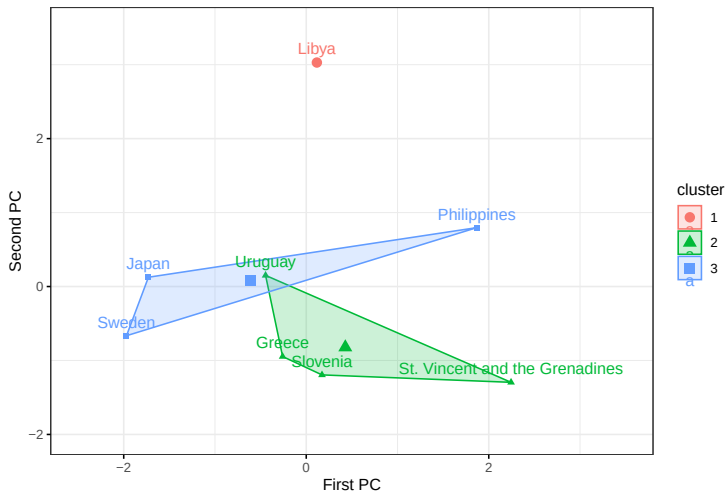
Some more data:

	LandArea	UrbanPopulation	LifeExpectancy	GDPPerCapita	MobileSubscriptions
1	1759540	88	73	8768	164
2	20136	55	82	23943	121
3	128900	78	82	19217	111
4	175020	95	78	17758	133
5	407280	88	83	53024	125
6	390	47	71	8295	93
7	298170	54	70	3576	151
8	364500	92	84	36044	147

Identified!

	country	LandArea	UrbanPopulation	LifeExpectancy	GDPPerCapita	MobileSubscriptions
	Libya	1759540	88	73	8768	164
	Slovenia	20136	55	82	23943	121
	Greece	128900	78	82	19217	111
	Uruguay	175020	95	78	17758	133
	Sweden	407280	88	83	53024	125
St. Vincent and the Grenadines		390	47	71	8295	93
	Philippines	298170	54	70	3576	151
	Japan	364500	92	84	36044	147

Part II: ML Results



A. “This Beloved Local Restaurant Is Closing After 78 Years” (= **82**)

B. “Man Accused of Child Abuse Faces Judge for First Time” (= **70**)

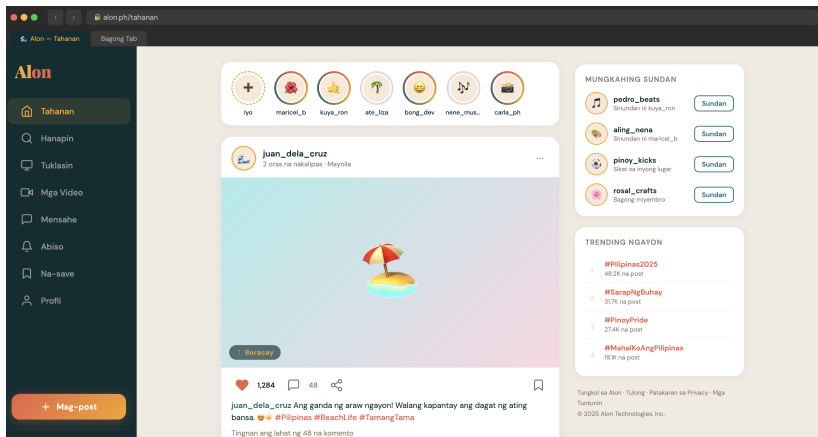
Ratings from <https://headlines.sharethrough.com>

A. “Will Your Health Insurance Really Protect You?” (= **76**)

B. “Which Oscar Nominee Had A Secret Life Before Film?” (= **65**)

A. “AI’s Impact on Your Financial Future,
Explained” (= **78**)

B. “Use This Stanford Psychologist’s Method
to Influence People” (= **72**)



“After the rain ended, she morffled over to her favorite spot by the bay to watch the rainbow disappear.”

morffle (mor-ful) *Verb* • To walk slowly and pensively, as if distracted.

Part VI: Return of the Spam

More test data:

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- .
- .
- 5. Re: Collaboration on U.S. state legislative activity

Human Behavior	Machine Analogue
Learning from examples	Supervised learning
Finding patterns	Unsupervised learning
Optimizing rewards	Reinforcement learning
Applying prior knowledge	Transfer learning
Generalizing from examples	One- or Few-shot learning
Aggregating judgments	Ensembles